

— PHASE I · FOUNDATIONS — A .LLAB™ WORKBOOK

Leadership Infrastructure Strength Map™

Identify one organizational strength and learn how to build infrastructure around it — instead of starting, as most do, with what's broken.

PHASE	INVESTMENT
I · Foundations	\$20

Start with what already **works**.

Most leadership work starts with a diagnosis of what's wrong. This workbook starts somewhere else: with what's already working, whether anyone has named it or not. That's not a warm-up exercise — it's the fastest, most reliable entry point into building real leadership infrastructure.

Why start here

Every organization has at least one strength that shows up consistently — a way of making decisions, a habit of communication, a pattern of execution — that produces good outcomes without heroic effort. Most leaders can't name it. It just happens, so it gets treated as luck instead of what it actually is: infrastructure that already exists, informally, and hasn't been reinforced on purpose.

Weaknesses get attention because they're loud. Strengths get ignored because they're quiet. The Strength Map reverses that — because infrastructure built around an existing strength takes a fraction of the effort of infrastructure built to force a new behavior into existence.

THE CORE IDEA

You don't build leadership infrastructure by fixing what's broken first. You build it by finding what already works, understanding why it works, and deliberately building the structure that lets it keep working — on purpose, without depending on any one person to carry it.

How to use this workbook

This is a single-sitting exercise — budget 30 to 45 minutes, ideally somewhere you won't be interrupted. Work through it in order: the Signal → Pattern → Infrastructure model on the next page gives you the lens, the Strength Map worksheet gives you the terrain, and the final section turns what you find into a first, concrete move. There's no wrong answer here — only clearer or less clear ones. Write in full sentences where you can; vague answers produce vague infrastructure.

Signal → Pattern → Infrastructure

Three questions turn a vague sense of "we're good at this" into something you can actually build around.

1 Signal — where do good outcomes keep showing up?

Not a one-time win. A pattern of results that keeps happening even when circumstances change — a client renewal rate, a project that always ships on time, a team that handles conflict without it becoming political. If it's happened three or more times without a single person forcing it, it's a signal.

2 Pattern — what is actually producing that outcome?

Strip away the personalities and look for the mechanism. Is it a habit of asking a certain question before decisions get made? A specific meeting rhythm? A norm about how disagreement gets voiced? The pattern is the reusable part — the thing that would still work with different people in the room.

3 Infrastructure — what would make the pattern survive without you?

This is the only step most organizations skip. A pattern that lives only in one leader's habits disappears the moment that leader is stretched thin, promoted, or gone. Infrastructure is the pattern written down, taught, and built into how the organization actually operates — a checklist, an onboarding step, a recurring ritual, a decision rule everyone can name.

Five domains where strength tends to hide

DOMAIN	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
Decision-Making	Decisions that get made quickly and stick, without repeated re-litigating.
Culture	Unwritten norms that new hires pick up fast, without anyone formally teaching them.
Communication	Information that reliably reaches the people who need it, without a bottleneck.
Execution	Work that ships consistently, without last-minute heroics to save it.
Relationships	Trust that lets people disagree productively instead of avoiding conflict.

Your Strength Map.

Pick the one domain from the table above where your answer came fastest — that's usually where the real signal lives. Work through all three questions for that domain before moving to a second one.

DOMAIN I'M MAPPING

SIGNAL — WHAT RESULT KEEPS HAPPENING, WITHOUT ANYONE FORCING IT?

PATTERN — WHAT IS ACTUALLY PRODUCING THAT RESULT?

WHO CURRENTLY CARRIES THIS PATTERN? (A PERSON, A TEAM, A HABIT)

WHAT HAPPENS TO THIS STRENGTH IF THAT PERSON IS UNAVAILABLE FOR A MONTH?

"If a strength depends on one person remembering to show up, it isn't infrastructure yet. It's a habit waiting to become infrastructure."

Build around it — **on purpose.**

Naming the strength is the diagnostic. This is the first real move toward infrastructure.

Three ways to build around what you found

- **Name it out loud.** Tell the team explicitly what you noticed and why it matters. Strengths that get named get reinforced; strengths that stay invisible quietly erode when priorities shift.
- **Write the pattern down.** One page is enough — the trigger, the behavior, the outcome. This is the seed of a real process, not a plaque on the wall.
- **Teach it once, on purpose.** Build it into how you onboard, brief, or review — the moment it depends on new people picking it up by osmosis, it starts to decay.

WHAT NOT TO DO

Don't try to fix your biggest weakness before you finish this. A strength you understand and reinforce will do more for your organization this quarter than a weakness you patch under pressure. Infrastructure gets built in the order that compounds fastest — and that's almost never the order that feels most urgent.

Where this fits

The Strength Map is Phase I — Foundations: understanding what's already true before you plan anything new. Once you can name a real strength and the pattern behind it, the next move is Phase II: connecting it to mission, vision, values, and strategy with the **Leadership Alignment Map™**, or turning it directly into a 30-day build with the **Leadership Infrastructure Build Plan™**.

You don't need to fix everything. You need to find the one thing that's already working — and build the infrastructure that keeps it working on purpose.